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Air conditioning system including a platform with remote access to a main body of an air conditioning apparatus and including multiple function layers

Abstract

An air conditioning system includes a main body device and a remote device. The main body device includes a hardware group and first software that controls the hardware group. The remote device includes an arithmetic processing unit and second software that controls the arithmetic processing unit. The first software includes a hardware access layer, a control layer, and a main body device-side function layer that accepts an order to the main body device and outputs a first instruction to the control layer. The second software includes a remote device-side function layer that accepts an order to the main body device and outputs a second instruction to the control layer via the main body device-side function layer. A function execution program that executes a function of the main body device is in at least one of the main body device-side function layer or the remote device-side function layer.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to an air conditioning system.

BACKGROUND

(2) These days, air conditioning apparatuses provide users with various functions such as a function of performing remote control from a portable terminal such as a smartphone via a network. These functions are implemented by software.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(3) Patent Literature 1: JP 2004-289505 A

SUMMARY

Technical Problem

(4) In a conventional air conditioning apparatus, its hardware (a compressor, a heat exchanger, a blower fan, etc.) and software that executes various functions are integrated in the main body of the air conditioning apparatus. Therefore, control on the main body of the air conditioning apparatus and collection of working information, etc. from the main body of the air conditioning apparatus basically need access to the main body of the air conditioning apparatus; hence, there has been a problem that the flexibility is limited and it is less easy to provide services such as maintenance service and function addition.

(5) The present invention solves the above problem, and an object of the present invention is to provide an air conditioning system including a platform with which access (control, information collection, etc.) to the main body of the air conditioning apparatus can be performed from various locations (the air conditioning apparatus, a cloud, etc.). Here, the platform is a function layer provided in each location.

Solution to Problem

(6) According to an aspect of an embodiment, the air conditioning system includes a main body device and a remote device. The main body device includes a hardware group that includes at least a compressor, a heat exchanger, and a blower fan, and software that controls the hardware group. The remote device includes at least an arithmetic processing unit and software that controls the arithmetic processing unit, and the remote device is connected to the main body device via a network. The software of the main body device includes a hardware access layer including a driver group that drives each piece of hardware, a control layer that controls the hardware group via the

driver group, and a main body device-side function layer that accepts an order to the main body device and outputs an instruction to the control layer. The software of the remote device includes a remote device-side function layer that accepts an order to the main body device and outputs an instruction to the control layer via the main body device-side function layer. Further, a function execution program that executes a function provided by the main body device is placed in at least one of the main body device-side function layer and the remote device-side function layer.

Advantageous Effects of Invention

(7) In the disclosed air conditioning system, access to the main body of the air conditioning apparatus can be performed from various locations.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a configuration of an air conditioning system according to an embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating a component configuration of software included in the air conditioning system.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system in the case where an airflow adjustment unit is placed in a cloud and a user changes the air volume or the air direction from a remote terminal.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system in the case where an airflow adjustment unit is placed in an indoor unit and a user changes the air volume or the air direction from an infrared remote controller.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system, centering on processing in a function layer.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating a case where an airflow adjustment unit is placed in a room.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating a case where an airflow adjustment unit is placed in a cloud and the airflow adjustment unit receives, from an air conditioner API processing unit, event-type responses to an air volume change instruction and an air direction change instruction.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(8) Hereinbelow, embodiments of an air conditioning system disclosed by the present application are described in detail on the basis of the drawings. Note that the air conditioning system disclosed by the present application is not limited by the following embodiments.

Embodiments

- (9) First, a configuration of an air conditioning system according to an embodiment is described. FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a configuration of the air conditioning system according to an embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. 1, an air conditioning system 1 according to an embodiment includes a GW (gateway) 2, a remote terminal 4, a cloud 5, an air conditioner 6, a remote controller 6c, a humidifier 7, and another device 8.
- (10) The GW (gateway) 2 is a device that controls the air conditioner 6 in response to a manipulation instruction from the remote terminal 4 or the cloud 5 via the Internet 3 (a network). The GW 2 includes a GW control unit 2a. The GW control unit 2a controls the GW 2.
- (11) The remote terminal 4 is a terminal that accepts a manipulation instruction from a user and controls the air conditioner 6 via the Internet 3 and the GW 2. The remote terminal 4 is, for example, a smartphone or a tablet. The remote terminal 4 includes a terminal control unit 4a. The terminal control unit 4a controls the remote terminal 4.
- (12) The cloud 5 is a system that controls the air conditioner 6 via the Internet 3 and the GW 2. The cloud 5 includes a plurality of information processing apparatuses 5a, and controls the air conditioner 6 by executing software in some of the plurality of information processing apparatuses

5a.

(13) The air conditioner **6** is an air conditioning apparatus having a cooling/heating function. The air conditioner **6** includes an outdoor unit **6a** and an indoor unit **6b**. The outdoor unit **6a** and the indoor unit **6b** are connected by a liquid pipe **6p** and a gas pipe **6q**.

(14) The remote controller **6c** performs wireless communication with the indoor unit **6b**. The remote controller **6c** is manipulated by the user, and transmits an instruction of the user to the indoor unit **6b** by using wireless communication. The remote controller **6c** includes a remote controller control unit **6s**. The remote controller control unit **6s** controls the remote controller **6c**. The remote controller **6c** includes an infrared remote controller and a BLE (Bluetooth (registered trademark, the same applies hereinafter) Low Energy) remote controller. The infrared remote controller communicates with the indoor unit **6b** by using infrared rays. The BLE remote controller communicates with the indoor unit **6b** by using Bluetooth.

(15) The outdoor unit **6a** includes a compressor **6d**, an outdoor heat exchanger **6e**, an outdoor fan **6f**, and an outdoor control unit **6g**. The outdoor unit **6a** exchanges heat between outdoor air taken in the outdoor unit **6a** and a refrigerant by using the outdoor heat exchanger **6e**. The outdoor unit **6a** draws air into the outdoor unit **6a** by using the outdoor fan **6f**. The refrigerant is compressed by the compressor **6d**, and circulates through the outdoor unit **6a**, the liquid pipe **6p**, the indoor unit **6b**, and the gas pipe **6q**. The outdoor control unit **6g** controls the outdoor unit **6a**.

(16) The indoor unit **6b** includes an indoor heat exchanger **6h**, an indoor fan **6i**, an air direction plate **6j**, and an indoor control unit **6k**. The indoor unit **6b** exchanges heat between indoor air taken in the indoor unit **6b** and the refrigerant by using the indoor heat exchanger **6h**. The indoor unit **6b** takes air into the indoor unit **6b** by using the indoor fan **6i**, and blows out, to the interior of the room, air subjected to heat exchange with the refrigerant. The air direction plate **6j** changes the direction of air blown out by the indoor fan **6i**. The indoor control unit **6k** controls the indoor unit **6b**.

(17) The humidifier **7** operates in coordination with the air conditioner **6**. For example, when the air conditioner **6** starts heating working, also the humidifier **7** starts operation if a coordination function is set.

(18) The other device **8** operates in coordination with the air conditioner **6** if a coordination function is set. The other device **8** is, for example, a household electric device such as a heater or an illuminator. Although only one other device **8** is illustrated in FIG. 1, the air conditioning system **1** may include a plurality of other devices **8**.

(19) The GW control unit **2a**, the terminal control unit **4a**, the outdoor control unit **6g**, the indoor control unit **6k**, and the remote controller control unit **6s** implement control functions by using software. The GW control unit **2a**, the terminal control unit **4a**, the outdoor control unit **6g**, the indoor control unit **6k**, and the remote controller control unit **6s** include CPUs (central processing units) **2b**, **4b**, **61b**, **62b**, and **63b** as arithmetic processing units, and memories **2c**, **4c**, **61c**, **62c**, and **63c**, respectively. These control units implement control functions by the CPUs **2b**, **4b**, **61b**, **62b**, and **63b** executing programs stored in the memories **2c**, **4c**, **61c**, **62c**, and **63c**, respectively.

(20) The information processing apparatus **5a** includes a CPU **5b** as an arithmetic processing unit and a memory **5c**, and controls the air conditioner **6** by the CPU **5b** executing a program stored in the memory **5c**.

(21) Next, a component configuration of software included in the air conditioning system **1** is described. FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating a component configuration of software included in the air conditioning system **1**. As illustrated in FIG. 2, the software included in the air conditioning system **1** according to the embodiment has a hierarchical structure including a driver layer **10**, a hardware abstraction layer **20**, a control layer **30**, and a function layer **40**.

(22) The driver layer **10** is a hardware access layer that accesses hardware **9**. Here, the hardware **9** includes the indoor heat exchanger **6h**, the indoor fan **6i**, the air direction plate **6j**, the compressor **6d**, the outdoor heat exchanger **6e**, and the outdoor fan **6f**. The components included in the driver

layer **10** control the hardware **9** on the basis of instructions of the components included in the hardware abstraction layer **20**, and return responses from the hardware **9** to the hardware abstraction layer **20**.

(23) The driver layer **10** includes, as components, a fan motor driver **11**, a stepping motor driver **12**, an outdoor unit driver **13**, an infrared communication module driver **14**, a wired communication driver **15**, a communication module driver compatible with the Wi-Fi standard (hereinafter, a WiFi module driver **16**), and a BLE module driver **17**.

(24) The fan motor driver **11**, the stepping motor driver **12**, and the outdoor unit driver **13** are placed in the indoor unit of the air conditioner **6**. The infrared communication module driver **14**, the wired communication driver **15**, the WiFi module driver **16**, and the BLE module driver **17** are placed in the indoor unit of the air conditioner **6**, and are also remotely placed. Here, the remote placement is placement in a location away from the indoor unit **6b**, such as the cloud **5**, the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, or the remote controller **6c**. Although the cloud **5** is a system including a plurality of information processing apparatuses **5a**, herein the cloud **5** is regarded as one apparatus.

(25) The fan motor driver **11** controls a fan motor that rotates the indoor fan **6i**. The stepping motor driver **12** controls, for example, a stepping motor that operates the air direction plate **6j**. The outdoor unit driver **13** controls, for example, the compressor **6d** included in the outdoor unit **6a** via communication with the outdoor unit **6a**.

(26) The infrared communication module driver **14** controls an infrared communication module that performs wireless communication by using infrared rays. The wired communication driver **15** controls a communication module that performs communication via a wired network. The WiFi module driver **16** controls a WiFi module that performs wireless communication compatible with the Wi-Fi standard. The BLE module driver **17** controls a Bluetooth module that performs wireless communication by using Bluetooth.

(27) The components included in the hardware abstraction layer **20**, based on instructions of the components included in the control layer **30**, instruct the components included in the driver layer **10** to control the hardware **9**, and return, to the control layer **30**, response signals indicating that the instructions from the control layer **30** are accepted. The components included in the driver layer **10**, based on instructions of the components included in the hardware abstraction layer **20**, instruct that the hardware be controlled. At this time, in the case where the hardware is controlled by what is called feedback control (control of comparing the value of the controlled variable with a target value and performing a correction operation so that the value of the controlled variable coincides with the target value), the hardware outputs response signals (feedback signals) for instructions to the driver layer **10**. The components of the driver layer **10** output feedback signals to the components of the hardware abstraction layer **20** in accordance with feedback signals from the hardware. A component of the hardware abstraction layer **20** that has received a feedback signal instructs a lower layer (hardware provided via the driver layer **10**) to perform additional control in accordance with the received feedback signal.

(28) The hardware abstraction layer **20** includes, as components, a fan control unit **21**, an air direction plate control unit **22**, an outdoor unit control unit **23**, an infrared communication control unit **24**, a wired communication control unit **25**, a WiFi communication control unit **26**, and a BLE communication control unit **27**. The fan control unit **21**, the air direction plate control unit **22**, and the outdoor unit control unit **23** are placed in the indoor unit. The infrared communication control unit **24**, the wired communication control unit **25**, the WiFi communication control unit **26**, and the BLE communication control unit **27** are placed in the indoor unit, and are also remotely placed.

(29) The fan control unit **21** controls the indoor fan **6i** by using the fan motor driver **11**. The air direction plate control unit **22** controls the air direction plate **6j** by using the stepping motor driver **12**. The outdoor unit control unit **23** controls, for example, the compressor **6d** included in the outdoor unit **6a** by using the outdoor unit driver **13**.

(30) The infrared communication control unit **24** controls infrared communication by using the

infrared communication module driver **14**. The wired communication control unit **25** controls communication performed via a wired network by using the wired communication driver **15**. The WiFi communication control unit **26** controls WiFi communication by using the WiFi module driver **16**. The BLE communication control unit **27** controls Bluetooth communication, which is wireless communication, by using the BLE module driver **17**.

(31) The hardware abstraction layer **20** provides the control layer **30** with a means for controlling abstracted hardware **9**. For example, the fan control unit **21** provides an air volume control unit **31** of the control layer **30** with a fan control means not depending on the kind of the fan motor or the kind of the fan.

(32) The components included in the control layer **30**, based on instructions of the functional units included in the function layer **40**, instruct the components included in the hardware abstraction layer **20** to control abstracted hardware **9**, and return responses from the hardware abstraction layer **20** to the function layer **40**. The control layer **30** includes, as components, an air volume control unit **31**, an air direction control unit **32**, a compressor control unit **33**, a communication control unit **34**, and a protection control unit **35**. The air volume control unit **31**, the air direction control unit **32**, the compressor control unit **33**, and the protection control unit **35** are placed in the indoor unit. The communication control unit **34** is placed in the indoor unit, and is also remotely placed.

(33) The air volume control unit **31** controls the volume of air outputted by the indoor fan **6i** by using the fan control unit **21**. The air direction control unit **32** controls the direction of air outputted by the indoor fan **6i** by using the air direction plate control unit **22**. The compressor control unit **33** controls, via the outdoor unit driver **13**, the compressor **6d** included in the outdoor unit **6a**.

(34) The communication control unit **34** controls communication between devices (remote devices) placed in different locations, such as the indoor unit **6b** and the GW **2**, the indoor unit **6b** and the remote terminal **4**, or the indoor unit **6b** and the cloud **5**, by using the infrared communication control unit **24**, the wired communication control unit **25**, the WiFi communication control unit **26**, or the BLE communication control unit **27**. The communication control unit **34** uses a communication protocol suitable for communication between the indoor unit **6b** and a remote device from among MQTT (Message Queue Telemetry Transport), CoAP (Constrained Application Protocol), REST (Representational State Transfer), a BLE service profile, and the like.

(35) The protection control unit **35** performs control regarding the protection of the hardware **9**. For example, the protection control unit **35** performs control so that the rotation rate of the indoor fan **6i** does not become too high.

(36) The control layer **30** provides a means for implementing the functions included in the function layer **40**. For example, the air volume control unit **31** and the air direction control unit **32** control the air volume and the air direction, respectively, to achieve airflow adjustment.

(37) The functional units included in the function layer **40** perform processing of implementing the functions that the air conditioning system **1** provides to the user. On the basis of a request (a change in a setting) of the user, among the functional units included in the function layer **40**, a functional unit that implements the request of the user performs processing of implementing the function. The function layer **40** includes, as functional units, an airflow adjustment unit **41**, a room temperature adjustment unit **42**, a remote control unit **43**, a comfortable airflow unit **44**, an automatic working unit **45**, an air conditioner-humidifier coordination unit **46**, other-device coordination units **47a**, **47b**, and **47c**, etc., for example.

(38) The airflow adjustment unit **41**, based on a setting by the user, adjusts the air volume of the indoor unit **6b** and the air direction of the indoor unit **6b** by using the air volume control unit **31** and the air direction control unit **32**, respectively. The room temperature adjustment unit **42** adjusts the capacity requested of the compressor **6d** included in the outdoor unit **6a** by using the compressor control unit **33** on the basis of the difference between a set temperature and the room temperature and the temporal change of the room temperature. The remote control unit **43** transmits a request that is set by the user by remote control with an infrared remote controller, a BLE remote

controller, the remote terminal **4**, or the like to the corresponding functional unit.

(39) The comfortable airflow unit **44** detects the floor temperature, etc., and automatically adjusts the air volume of the indoor unit **6b** by using the air volume control unit **31** so as to eliminate temperature unevenness in the room. The automatic working unit **45** automatically chooses a working mode (cooling, drying, blowing, or heating) on the basis of the indoor temperature and the outside air temperature, and performs working according to the chosen working mode. The air conditioner-humidifier coordination unit **46** coordinates the operation of the air conditioner **6** and the operation of the humidifier **7**. The other-device coordination units **47a**, **47b**, **47c**, etc. coordinate the operation of the air conditioner **6** and the operations of other devices **8**. Examples of the other device **8** include a not-illustrated curtain, a not-illustrated lighting device, etc. For example, control signals from the other-device coordination units **47a**, **47b**, **47c**, etc. are sent to other devices **8** through the air conditioner API processing unit, and thereby the air conditioner **6** and the other devices **8** are coordinated. By providing the other-device coordination units, coordination with other devices can be made even when the air conditioner side is not mounted with sensors needed for control of the other devices (for example, a brightness sensor, etc.).

(40) The functional units included in the function layer **40** may be placed in the indoor unit **6b**, or may be placed in a remote device such as the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, the cloud **5**, or the remote controller **6c**. Further, the functional units included in the function layer **40** are implemented by the CPUs **2b**, **4b**, **5b**, **61b**, **62b**, and **63b** executing function execution programs created individually for the functions.

(41) The function layer **40** includes an air conditioner data unit **51**, an air conditioner API (application programming interface) processing unit **52**, and an air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53**. The air conditioner data unit **51**, the air conditioner API processing unit **52**, and the air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53** are placed in a location where functional units are placed, such as the indoor unit **6b**, the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, or the cloud **5**.

(42) The air conditioner data unit **51** manages data shared between functional units placed in different devices; when data is updated on the side of one remotely placed device, the air conditioner data unit **51** performs updating to the updated content (synchronizes data) also on the side of another device, and thereby maintains the consistency of data. The air conditioner data unit **51** synchronizes data distributed and stored in physical memories of the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, the cloud **5**, the remote controller **6c**, etc., and maintains the consistency of data as a whole air conditioner system. The data managed by the air conditioner data unit **51** is used for conflict control or arbitration between functional units. In this way, the air conditioner system can virtually have a memory integrated as a whole system (an integrated memory **50**).

(43) That is, the integrated memory **50** is a memory as a concept in which physical memories of the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, the cloud **5**, the remote controller **6c**, etc. are virtually integrated.

(44) Regardless of whether functional units are physically placed in the cloud **5**, the GW **2**, the remote terminal **4**, the remote controller **6c**, or any other place, the air conditioner API processing unit **52** can use the same functional unit independently of the placement location (standardize functional units) by providing a common API to functional units. The air conditioner API processing unit **52** performs, via the air conditioner data unit **51**, communication switching and instructions from the function layer **40** to the control layer **30**. The air conditioner API processing unit **52** grasps the placement of the functional units and the components of the control layer placed in a plurality of devices, and performs control so that control signals and response signals are appropriately communicated.

(45) The air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53** performs control of coordination between remotely placed functional units. For example, the air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53** performs an operation of changing a setting by remotely placed functional units (for example, whether to activate the airflow adjustment function of the airflow adjustment unit or not), etc.

(46) Next, sequences of processing of the air conditioning system **1** are described using FIG. 3 to FIG. 6, taking airflow adjustment as an example. In FIG. 3 to FIG. 6, in the indoor unit **6b**, an air conditioner data unit **51a**, an air conditioner API processing unit **52a**, an air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53a**, a remote control unit **43a**, a communication control unit **34a**, a WiFi communication control unit **26a**, a WiFi module driver **16a**, an infrared communication control unit **24a**, and an infrared communication module driver **14a** operate. In the cloud **5**, an air conditioner data unit **51b**, an air conditioner API processing unit **52b**, and an air conditioner inter-function coordination unit **53b** operate. A real memory **50a** is, out of the integrated memory **50**, which is a virtual memory, a physical memory placed in the indoor unit **6b**, and a real memory **50b** is, out of the integrated memory **50**, which is a virtual memory, a physical memory placed in the cloud **5**.

(47) First, a case where an airflow adjustment unit **41b** is placed in the cloud **5** and the user changes the air volume or the air direction from the remote terminal **4** is described. FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system **1** in the case where an airflow adjustment unit **41b** is placed in the cloud **5** and the user changes the air volume or the air direction from the remote terminal **4**. As illustrated in FIG. 3, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** placed in the cloud **5** receives an air volume change instruction from the remote terminal **4** (S1). Here, first, a case where the air volume is changed is described; the airflow adjustment unit **41b** outputs a control signal that requests a change in the setting of the air volume or the air direction regardless of the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41b** itself. Specifically, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** outputs an air volume change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**. Since the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** grasps that the air volume control unit **31** and the air direction control unit **32**, which are components of the control layer, are in the main body device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** converts the air volume change control signal into data for communication with the main body device (a WiFi signal), and transmits the data to the main body device via the Internet (S2). Here, the main body device is the air conditioner **6**.

(48) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** transmits the data for communication to the main body device via the air conditioner data unit **51b**, and the air conditioner data unit **51b** changes the setting of the air volume and stores the changed setting in the real memory **50b**. The air conditioner data unit **51b** synchronizes with the air conditioner data unit **51a** of the indoor unit **6b** to maintain the consistency of the integrated memory **50**. Thus, the air conditioner data unit **51a** can acquire the changed setting of the air volume from the real memory **50a** of the indoor unit **6b**.

(49) The WiFi module driver **16a** of the driver layer **10** of the main body device receives data that has been transmitted from the cloud **5** via the Internet, and outputs the data to the WiFi communication control unit **26a** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The WiFi communication control unit **26a** checks whether the data received by the WiFi module driver **16a** is proper received data or not; when the data is proper received data, the WiFi communication control unit **26a** outputs the received data to the communication control unit **34a** of the control layer **30**.

(50) The communication control unit **34a** performs signal analysis on the data (received data) transmitted from the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**; when the data is the air volume change control signal from the airflow adjustment unit **41b** on the cloud **5** side, the communication control unit **34a** sends the air volume change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** on the main body side (S3).

(51) Since the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** grasps the placement of the air volume control unit **31** to receive the air volume change control signal, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** can output the air volume change control signal toward the air volume control unit **31** (S4). The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** also causes the air conditioner data unit **51a** to store the fact that the air volume change instruction has been issued.

(52) The air volume control unit **31** determines the target fan rotation rate after change on the basis

of the air volume change instruction, and outputs the target fan rotation rate as a control signal to the fan control unit **21** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. At the time point when the acceptance of the air volume change instruction from the air volume control unit **31** is completed, the fan control unit **21** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air volume control unit **31**; and calculates the controlled variable of the fan motor from the difference between the current actual operating fan rotation rate and the target fan rotation rate after change, and outputs the controlled variable of the fan motor as a control signal to the fan motor driver **11** of the driver layer **10**. The fan motor driver **11** outputs a signal to a fan motor drive circuit in accordance with the controlled variable of the fan motor, and controls the fan motor (S5).

(53) After that, the fan motor driver **11** of the driver layer **10** inputs, from a fan motor rotation rate feedback circuit of the hardware **9**, a feedback signal (pulse signal) of the actual operating fan rotation rate after the controlled variable of the fan motor is changed, as a response signal (S6). The fan motor driver **11** outputs the time interval of the feedback signal input (the time interval of the pulse signal) as a response signal to the fan control unit **21** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The fan control unit **21** calculates the rotation rate of the fan motor from the time interval of the feedback signal input (the time interval of the pulse signal), and instructs the fan motor driver **11** to increase a command voltage value (the ON time of a PWM signal) up to a predetermined rotation rate. At the time point when the acceptance of the air volume change instruction from the air volume control unit **31** is completed, the fan control unit **21** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air volume control unit **31**; and the air volume control unit **31** that has received the acceptance response signal outputs a response signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40** (S7).

(54) The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** performs data conversion into a response signal suitable for the control signal transmitted from the airflow adjustment unit **41b** of the function layer **40** placed in the cloud **5**, and outputs the response signal to the communication control unit **34a** of the control layer **30** (S8).

(55) In order to communicate with the cloud **5**, the communication control unit **34a** chooses WiFi communication, and outputs a response signal to the WiFi communication control unit **26a** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The WiFi communication control unit **26a** converts the inputted response signal into a Universal Asynchronous Receiver/Transmitter (UART) signal, and outputs the UART signal to the WiFi module driver **16a** of the driver layer **10**. The WiFi module driver **16a** transmits a response signal to the cloud **5** through a communication circuit (S9).

(56) In this way, the fan motor driver **11**, the fan control unit **21**, the air volume control unit **31**, and the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** sequentially convert a response signal of the previous layer into a suitable format, and sequentially output the converted response signal to the next layer; thus, the air conditioning system **1** can transmit a response signal from the hardware **9** to the cloud **5**. Note that the air volume control unit **31** makes a response regardless of the placement of the airflow adjustment unit **41**. Specifically, the air volume control unit **31** responds to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a**, and the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** responds to the communication control unit **34a**. Details of an event-type response will be described later. The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** may make a response by asynchronous response via an integrated memory or polling.

(57) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** of the function layer **40** of the cloud **5** inputs, as a response signal, a signal transmitted from the main body device via the Internet, converts the inputted response signal, and outputs the converted response signal to the airflow adjustment unit **41b**. Thus, the air volume change processing is completed.

(58) Next, an air direction change is described. As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** placed in the cloud **5** receives an air direction change instruction from the remote terminal **4** (S1). Then, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** outputs the air direction change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** regardless of the placement of the airflow adjustment unit **41b**.

itself. Since the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** grasps that the air direction control unit **32**, which are components of the control layer, are in the main body device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** converts the air direction change control signal into data for communication with the main body device (a WiFi signal), and transmits the data to the main body device via the Internet (S2).

(59) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** transmits the data for communication to the main body device via the air conditioner data unit **51b**, and the air conditioner data unit **51b** changes the setting of the air direction and stores the changed setting in the real memory **50b**. The air conditioner data unit **51b** synchronizes with the air conditioner data unit **51a** to maintain the consistency of the integrated memory **50**. Thus, the air conditioner data unit **51a** can acquire the changed setting of the air direction from the real memory **50a** of the indoor unit **6b**.

(60) The WiFi module driver **16a** of the driver layer **10** of the main body device receives data that has been transmitted from the cloud **5** via the Internet, and outputs the data to the WiFi communication control unit **26a** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The WiFi communication control unit **26a** checks whether the data received by the WiFi module driver **16a** is proper received data or not; when the data is proper received data, the WiFi communication control unit **26a** outputs the received data to the communication control unit **34a** of the control layer **30**.

(61) The communication control unit **34a** performs signal analysis on the data (received data) transmitted from the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**; when the data is the air direction change control signal from the airflow adjustment unit **41b** on the cloud **5** side, the communication control unit **34a** sends the air direction change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** on the main body side (S3).

(62) Since the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** grasps the placement of the air direction control unit **32** to receive the air direction change control signal, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** can output the air direction change control signal toward the air direction control unit **32** (S10). The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** also causes the air conditioner data unit **51a** to store the fact that the air direction change instruction has been issued.

(63) The air direction control unit **32** determines the number of pulses for the target air direction position after change on the basis of the air direction change instruction, and outputs the number of pulses for the target air direction position as a control signal to the air direction plate control unit **22** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. At the time point when the acceptance of the air direction change instruction from the air direction control unit **32** is completed, the air direction plate control unit **22** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air direction control unit **32**; and determines the driving direction of the stepping motor from the number of pulses for the current actual operating air direction position and the number of pulses for the target air direction position after change, and outputs the controlled variable of the stepping motor as a control signal to the stepping motor driver **12** of the driver layer **10**. The stepping motor driver **12** outputs a signal to a stepping motor drive circuit at a timing according to the controlled variable of the stepping motor, and drives the stepping motor; thus, controls the air direction position (S11).

(64) With regard to the stepping motor that controls the air direction plate, since there is no hardware circuit that detects the air direction position, there is no response signal input from a lower layer to the stepping motor driver **12** of the driver layer **10** or the air direction plate control unit **22** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. At the time point when the acceptance of the air direction change instruction from the air direction control unit **32** of the control layer **30** is completed, the air direction plate control unit **22** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air direction control unit **32**. The air direction control unit **32** outputs a response signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40** (S12).

(65) The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** performs data conversion into a response signal suitable for the control signal transmitted from the airflow adjustment unit **41b** of the function layer **40** placed in the cloud **5**, and outputs the response signal to the communication control unit **34a** of

the control layer **30** (S8).

(66) In order to communicate with the cloud **5**, the communication control unit **34a** chooses WiFi communication, and outputs a response signal to the WiFi communication control unit **26a** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The WiFi communication control unit **26a** converts the inputted response signal into a UART signal, and outputs the UART signal to the WiFi module driver **16a** of the driver layer **10**. The WiFi module driver **16a** transmits a response signal to the cloud **5** through a communication circuit (S9).

(67) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** of the function layer **40** of the cloud **5** inputs, as a response signal, a signal transmitted from the main body device via the Internet, converts the inputted response signal, and outputs the converted response signal to the airflow adjustment unit **41b**. Thus, the air direction change processing is completed.

(68) Next, a case where an airflow adjustment unit **41a** is placed in the indoor unit **6b** and the user has changed the air volume or the air direction from an infrared remote controller is described. FIG. **4** is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system **1** in the case where an airflow adjustment unit **41a** is placed in the indoor unit **6b** and the user changes the air volume or the air direction from an infrared remote controller. As illustrated in FIG. **4**, the infrared communication module driver **14a** of the driver layer **10** of the indoor unit **6b** receives an air volume change instruction based on a manipulation of the user from an infrared remote controller (S21). Then, the infrared communication module driver **14a** outputs the received signal to the infrared communication control unit **24a**.

(69) The infrared communication control unit **24a** analyzes the received signal and identifies the received signal as an air volume change instruction, and outputs the air volume change instruction to the communication control unit **34a** of the control layer **30**. The communication control unit **34a** assesses the priority in comparison with instruction inputs from other communication means, etc.; when there is no problem, the communication control unit **34a** outputs the air volume change instruction to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40**. At this time, since the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** grasps that the remote control unit **43a**, which is a functional unit, is placed in the function layer on the main body side, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** transmits the air volume change instruction to the remote control unit **43a** (S22). The remote control unit **43a** directly outputs the air volume change instruction to the airflow adjustment unit **41a** of the function layer **40** in the main body device (S23). The airflow adjustment unit **41a** of the function layer **40** that has received the air volume change instruction outputs an air volume change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** regardless of the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41a** itself. Since the air volume change control signal is a control signal from the airflow adjustment unit **41a** in the same device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** outputs the air volume change control signal as it is without data conversion into communication data to the air volume control unit **31** of the control layer **30** (S24).

(70) The air volume control unit **31** determines the target fan rotation rate after change on the basis of the air volume change instruction, and outputs the target fan rotation rate as a control signal to the fan control unit **21** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The fan control unit **21** calculates the controlled variable of the fan motor from the difference between the current actual operating fan rotation rate and the target fan rotation rate after change, and outputs the controlled variable of the fan motor as a control signal to the fan motor driver **11** of the driver layer **10**. The fan motor driver **11** outputs a signal to a fan motor drive circuit at a timing in accordance with the controlled variable of the fan motor, and controls the fan motor (S25).

(71) After that, the fan motor driver **11** of the driver layer **10** inputs, from a fan motor rotation rate feedback circuit of the hardware **9**, a feedback signal of the actual operating fan rotation rate after the controlled variable of the fan motor is changed, as a response signal (S26). The fan motor driver **11** outputs the time interval of the feedback signal input as a response signal to the fan

control unit **21** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. At the time point when the acceptance of the air volume change instruction from the air volume control unit **31** of the control layer **30** is completed, the fan control unit **21** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air volume control unit **31**. The air volume control unit **31** outputs a response signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40** regardless of the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41** (S27).

(72) Since the airflow adjustment unit **41a** is in the same device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** outputs the response signal as it is without data conversion to the airflow adjustment unit **41a**. Thus, the air volume change processing is completed.

(73) As illustrated in FIG. 3 and FIG. 4, the airflow adjustment unit **41**, regardless of whether it is placed in the cloud **5** or the indoor unit **6b**, upon receiving an air volume change instruction, outputs an air volume change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52** regardless of the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41** itself. Then, in the case where the air conditioner API processing unit **52** is placed in the cloud **5**, since the air conditioner API processing unit **52** grasps that the air volume control unit **31** is placed in the main body device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52** converts the air volume change control signal into data for communication with the main body device, and transmits the data to the main body device. Hence, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** can control the air volume of the indoor unit **6b** from the cloud **5** by the same processing as that in the case of being placed in the indoor unit **6b**. Thus, in the air conditioning system **1**, the airflow adjustment unit **41** can be placed in either of the indoor unit **6b** and the cloud **5**.

(74) Next, an air direction change is described. As illustrated in FIG. 4, the infrared communication module driver **14a** of the driver layer **10** of the indoor unit **6b** receives an air direction change instruction based on a manipulation of the user from an infrared remote controller (S21). Then, the infrared communication module driver **14a** outputs the received signal to the infrared communication control unit **24a**.

(75) The infrared communication control unit **24a** analyzes the received signal and identifies the received signal as an air direction change instruction, and outputs the air direction change instruction to the communication control unit **34a** of the control layer **30**. The communication control unit **34a** assesses the priority in comparison with instruction inputs from other communication means, etc.; when there is no problem, the communication control unit **34a** outputs the air direction change instruction to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40**. At this time, since the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** grasps that the remote control unit **43a**, which is a functional unit, is placed in the function layer on the main body side, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** transmits the air direction change instruction to the remote control unit **43a** (S22). The remote control unit **43a** directly outputs the air direction change instruction to the airflow adjustment unit **41a** of the function layer **40** in the main body device (S23). The airflow adjustment unit **41a** of the function layer **40** that has received the air direction change instruction outputs an air direction change control signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** without being conscious the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41a** itself. Since the air direction change control signal is a control signal from the airflow adjustment unit **41a** in the same device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** outputs the air direction change control signal as it is without data conversion into communication data to the air direction control unit **32** of the control layer **30** (S28).

(76) The air direction control unit **32** determines the target air direction position and the number of pulses for the target air direction position after change on the basis of the air direction change instruction, and outputs the number of pulses for the target air direction position as a control signal to the air direction plate control unit **22** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. The air direction plate control unit **22** determines the driving direction of the stepping motor from the number of pulses for the current actual operating air direction position and the number of pulses for the target air

direction position after change. Then, the air direction plate control unit **22** outputs a stepping motor drive signal as a control signal to the stepping motor driver **12** of the driver layer **10** until the number of pulses reaches the number of pulses for the target air direction position. The stepping motor driver **12** outputs a signal to a stepping motor drive circuit, and drives the stepping motor; thus, controls the air direction position (S29).

(77) With regard to the stepping motor that controls the air direction plate, since there is no hardware circuit that detects the air direction position, there is no response signal input from a lower layer to the stepping motor driver **12** of the driver layer **10** or the air direction plate control unit **22** of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. At the time point when the acceptance of the air volume change instruction from the air direction control unit **32** of the control layer **30** is completed, the air direction plate control unit **22** outputs an acceptance response signal to the air direction control unit **32**. Similarly, at the time point when the acceptance of the air direction change instruction from the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** of the function layer **40** is completed, the air direction control unit **32** outputs a response signal to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** regardless of the placement location of the airflow adjustment unit **41** (S30).

(78) Since the airflow adjustment unit **41a** is in the same device, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** outputs the response signal as it is without data conversion to the airflow adjustment unit **41a**. Thus, the air direction change processing is completed.

(79) Next, a case where an airflow adjustment unit **41b** is placed in the cloud **5** and the user changes the air volume or the air direction from an infrared remote controller is described. FIG. **5** is the same as FIG. **3** in that an airflow adjustment unit **41b** is placed in the cloud **5**, but is different in that the user changes the air volume or the air direction from an infrared remote controller. FIG. **5** is a diagram illustrating a sequence of processing by the air conditioning system **1**, centering on processing in the function layer **40**.

(80) As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the user changes the air volume and the air direction with an infrared remote controller (1). The remote control unit **43a** accepts a change instruction (2), and stores the change contents of the setting (air volume= x , air direction= y) in the real memory **50a** of the indoor unit **6b** (3). The air conditioner data unit **51a** of the indoor unit **6b** and the air conditioner data unit **51b** of the cloud **5** coordinate to synchronize the contents between the real memory **50a** of the indoor unit **6b** and the real memory **50b** of the cloud **5** (4). The air conditioner data unit **51a** of the indoor unit **6b** and the air conditioner data unit **51b** of the cloud **5** synchronize the contents between the real memory **50a** and the real memory **50b** by copying the contents of the real memory **50a** to the real memory **50b**. When the setting is changed, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** of the cloud **5** refers to the change contents of the setting in the real memory **50b** (5), and uses a function call to request the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** to change the setting of the air volume and the air direction (6). The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** converts the setting change request into communication data, and transmits the communication data to the indoor unit **6b** (7).

(81) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** of the indoor unit **6b** receives the setting change request, and converts the setting change request into an air volume setting change request and an air direction setting change request (a function call) (8). Then, the air volume and the air direction are changed on the basis of the air volume setting change request and the air direction setting change request (9).

(82) FIG. **6** illustrates a case where an airflow adjustment unit **41a** is placed in the indoor unit **6b**. As illustrated in FIG. **6**, the user changes the air volume and the air direction with an infrared remote controller (11). The remote control unit **43a** accepts a change instruction (12), and stores the change contents of the setting (air volume= x , air direction= y) in the real memory **50a** of the indoor unit **6b** (13).

(83) When the setting is changed, the airflow adjustment unit **41a** of the indoor unit **6b** refers to the change contents of the setting in the real memory **50a** (14), and uses a function call to request the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** to change the setting of the air volume and the air direction

(15). The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** requests the air volume control unit **31** to change the setting of the air volume, and requests the air direction control unit **32** to change the setting of the air direction. Then, the air volume and the air direction are changed (16).

(84) As illustrated in FIG. 5 and FIG. 6, when a setting in the integrated memory **50** is changed, the airflow adjustment unit **41**, regardless of whether it is placed in the cloud **5** or the indoor unit **6b**, requests the air conditioner API processing unit **52** to change the setting of the air volume and the air direction. Then, when placed in the cloud **5**, the air conditioner API processing unit **52** converts the setting change request into communication data, and transmits the communication data to the indoor unit **6b**. Hence, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** can control the air volume and the air direction of the indoor unit **6b** from the cloud **5** by the same processing as that in the case of being placed in the indoor unit **6b**. Thus, in the air conditioning system **1**, the airflow adjustment unit **41** can be placed in either of the indoor unit **6b** and the cloud **5**.

(85) Next, details of an event-type response in which a response signal is processed when an event (reception of a response signal) occurs are described. FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating a case where an airflow adjustment unit **41b** is placed in the cloud **5** (that is, the case of the embodiments illustrated in FIG. 3 and FIG. 5) and the airflow adjustment unit **41b** receives, from the air conditioner API processing unit **52a**, event-type responses to an air volume change instruction and an air direction change instruction. FIG. 7 illustrates, as an example, a case where the MQTT protocol is employed and a publish-subscribe model in which when a response signal is published to an MQTT server, the response signal is transmitted to a subscribing terminal is applied.

(86) As illustrated in FIG. 7, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** registers, in the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**, Callback functions that expect responses of an air volume change and an air direction change from the indoor unit side (21). That is, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** registers, in the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**, an air volume Callback function and an air direction Callback function while associating them with air volume control and air direction control, respectively.

(87) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** holds the Callback functions while associating them with events (22). That is, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** holds {an air direction Callback function, an air direction control event} and {an air volume Callback function, an air volume control event}. Further, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** registers, from a communication control unit **34b** to an MQTT server **54**, an air volume control event and an air direction control event on the indoor unit side, as messages to be subscribed to.

(88) When an event (an acceptance response of an air volume change signal or an acceptance response of an air direction change signal) occurs, the control unit (the air volume control unit **31** or the air direction control unit **32**) of the indoor unit **6b** delivers the event to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** (23). The air conditioner API processing unit **52a** publishes the event that has occurred in order to convey information of the event to the cloud side (24). That is, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** publishes an air volume control event when an acceptance response of an air volume change signal occurs as an event, and publishes an air direction control event when an acceptance response of an air direction change signal occurs as an event. The published event is delivered as a message from the communication control unit **34a** to the cloud side via the MQTT server.

(89) The air conditioner API processing unit **52b** of the cloud **5** receives an event delivered from the communication control unit **34a** via the MQTT server, and activates a Callback function associated with the received event (25). That is, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** activates an air volume Callback function when the published event is an air volume control event, and activates an air direction Callback function when the published event is an air direction control event.

(90) In this way, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** registers a Callback function in the air conditioner API processing unit **52b**. Then, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** holds the Callback

function while associating it with an event; when an event is published, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** activates a Callback function associated with the published event. Thus, the airflow adjustment unit **41b** can receive a response to an instruction.

(91) As described hereinabove, the air conditioning system **1** includes an air conditioner API processing unit **52a** in the indoor unit **6b**, and includes an air conditioner API processing unit **52b** in the cloud **5** as an example of a remote device. The functional units placed in the cloud **5** perform processing via the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** and the air conditioner API processing unit **52a**. That is, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** and the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** function as a platform (platform API) with which access (control, information collection, etc.) to the main body of the air conditioning apparatus can be performed from various locations (the air conditioning apparatus, a cloud, etc.). Thus, in the air conditioning system **1**, functional units can be remotely placed.

(92) Further, in the embodiment, the functional units included in the function layer **40** perform similar processing regardless of whether they are placed in the indoor unit **6b** or a remote device. Thus, the air conditioning system **1** can develop a common functional unit not depending on the placement location, and can easily develop functional units. For example, it is not needed to provide communication processing as processing of the functional unit, and the air conditioner API processing unit **52** performs communication via the communication control unit **34** when needed. Thus, the air conditioning system **1** can develop a common functional unit not depending on the placement location, and can easily develop functional units.

(93) Further, in the embodiment, when a functional unit is placed in the cloud **5**, the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** converts an instruction from the functional unit into a format suitable for communication, and transmits the converted instruction to the air conditioner API processing unit **52a**. Then, the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** converts the instruction received from the air conditioner API processing unit **52b** into a format suitable for the control layer **30**, and outputs the converted instruction to a component of the control layer **30**. Then, the component of the control layer **30** converts the instruction received from the air conditioner API processing unit **52a** into a format suitable for the hardware abstraction layer **20**, and outputs the converted instruction to a component of the hardware abstraction layer **20**. Then, the component of the hardware abstraction layer **20** converts the instruction received from the component of the control layer **30** into a format suitable for the driver layer **10**, and output the converted instruction to a component of the driver layer **10**. Thus, the air conditioning system **1** can develop a functional unit and a component based only on the interface with the layer immediately below, and can easily develop functional units and components.

(94) Further, in the embodiment, a remotely placed functional unit receives a response to an instruction to the indoor unit **6b** on the basis of a publish-subscribe model, and therefore can check that the indoor unit **6b** has executed the instruction.

(95) Further, in the embodiment, a functional unit can share data with another functional unit by means of the virtual integrated memory **50** without depending on the placement location, and can easily exchange data with the other functional unit. Further, in the embodiment, the air conditioner data unit **51** maintains the consistency of data between functional units by means of the virtual integrated memory **50**. Thus, the hardware **9** of the indoor unit **6b** can stably operate without receiving contradictory instructions from identical functional units placed in different locations.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(96) **1** AIR CONDITIONING SYSTEM **2** GW **2b**, **4b**, **5b**, **61b**, **62b**, **63b** CPU **4** REMOTE TERMINAL **5** CLOUD **6** AIR CONDITIONER **6a** OUTDOOR UNIT **6b** INDOOR UNIT **6c** REMOTE CONTROLLER **10** DRIVER LAYER **20** HARDWARE ABSTRACTION LAYER **30** CONTROL LAYER **40** FUNCTION LAYER **50** INTEGRATED MEMORY **51**, **51a**, **51b** AIR CONDITIONER DATA UNIT **52**, **52a**, **52b** AIR CONDITIONER API PROCESSING UNIT **53**, **53a**, **53b** AIR CONDITIONER INTER-FUNCTION COORDINATION UNIT

Claims

1. An air conditioning system, comprising: a main body device including a hardware group that includes at least a compressor, a heat exchanger, and a blower fan, and first software that controls the hardware group; and a remote device including at least an arithmetic processing unit and second software that controls the arithmetic processing unit, the remote device being connected to the main body device via a network, wherein the first software of the main body device includes: a hardware access layer including a driver group that drives each piece of the hardware group; a control layer that controls the hardware group via the driver group; and a main body device-side function layer that accepts a first order to the main body device and outputs a first instruction to the control layer, the second software of the remote device includes: a remote device-side function layer that accepts a second order to the main body device and outputs a second instruction to the control layer via the main body device-side function layer, and a function execution program that executes at least one function of the main body device is in at least one of the main body device-side function layer or the remote device-side function layer.
2. The air conditioning system according to claim 1, wherein the function execution program is individually created for each function of the main body device.
3. The air conditioning system according to claim 1, wherein, in a case where the function execution program is in the remote device-side function layer: the second order accepted by the remote device-side function layer is converted into a first format suitable for being inputted to the main body device-side function layer via the network in the remote device-side function layer and is output by the remote device-side function layer to the main body device-side function layer; the first order accepted by the main body device-side function layer is converted into a second format suitable for the control layer and is output by the main body device-side function layer to the control layer as the first instruction; the first instruction is converted into a third format suitable for the hardware access layer in the control layer and is output by the control layer to the hardware access layer as a third instruction; and the third instruction is converted into a fourth format suitable for a piece of the hardware group in the hardware access layer and is output by the hardware access layer to the piece of the hardware group.
4. The air conditioning system according to claim 3, wherein a response signal that the piece of the hardware group returns in response to the converted third instruction is sequentially converted into suitable formats in the hardware access layer, the control layer, the main body device-side function layer, and the remote device-side function layer, and is sequentially output to respective layers.
5. The air conditioning system according to claim 1, wherein a first physical memory included in the main body device and a second physical memory included in the remote device are integrated as a virtual integrated memory in which consistency is maintained, and the function execution program exchanges data with another function execution program by using the virtual integrated memory.
6. The air conditioning system according to claim 1, wherein the first software of the main body device includes a hierarchical structure, the hierarchical structure including the hardware access layer, the control layer, and the main body device-side function layer.
7. The air conditioning system according to claim 6, wherein the remote device-side function layer of the remote device is in a same level of the hierarchical structure as the main body device-side function layer of the main body device.
8. The air conditioning system according to claim 1, wherein the control layer of the first software of the main body device, which receives the second instruction from the remote device-side function layer second software of the remote device, includes a communication control unit that

controls communication between plural remote devices in different locations, the plural remote devices including the remote device.
